

Week 14: Beauty

BIG IDEA

Beauty, agency, and story may seem strange topics, but don't gloss over them: they are important pointers to God in students' everyday lives. This week is mainly an evaluation stop: figure out where each student actually is, answer recurring questions head on, and adjust before moving into the year's second half.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- The next lessons are easier than recent months but still incredibly important pointers to God, showing he is present in things students interact with daily.
- Take stock of where students are now versus their questions and beliefs at the start; check old notes for change, good or bad.
- Keep five or six Essentials books on hand so new students can be brought up to speed quickly without feeling intimidated mid-study.
- If the same questions keep recurring, pause and answer them head on; students hung up on a question often can't move on until it's answered.
- Notice who's tracking, but don't fixate on engaged students for affirmation or on one skeptic as your project; don't forget everyone in the middle.
- Engage the silently skeptical student one-on-one, not publicly; the speaker's arms-folded student eventually admitted 'there's something to what you're saying.'

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Where is each of your students now compared to the questions and beliefs they walked in with?
2. What recurring questions keep coming up, and do you need to pause and answer them head on before moving forward?
3. Which quiet student in the back seems to be 'not buying it,' and how could you engage them one-on-one?
4. Do you keep going as planned, or put the brakes on and revisit an old lesson before the next half of the year?

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